

Atlas Glossary of Terms

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This is a living document. Entries marked △ **Needs review** contain definitions that are inferred or approximate — they should be verified and corrected by the relevant team before being treated as authoritative.

How to use this glossary

- Terms are grouped by category, then listed alphabetically within each group.
 - **Bold** the first use of any glossary term in a document and link back here where practical.
 - To add or correct a definition, edit this file and update the version date at the top.
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Categories

1. [Product and Strategy](#)
 2. [Milestones and Dates](#)
 3. [Use Case Taxonomy](#)
 4. [Architecture and Platform](#)
 5. [IBM Z Technology](#)
 6. [Data Sources and Integrations](#)
 7. [Commercial and Packaging](#)
 8. [Metrics and Measurement](#)
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1. Product and Strategy

Application Deployment Engine A shared Atlas GA capability that deploys application components and associated resources from the Atlas topology graph into a specified provisioned Atlas environment. The Application Deployment Engine operates after the environment is provisioned and before test execution begins — it is the bridge between "environment exists" and "applications are running and ready to test." It is a general-purpose capability reusable across any Atlas use case that requires applications to be deployed into a provisioned environment: PTF validation, middleware patch testing, and future application change scenarios. It does not perform application code changes; that is UC-07 (Application Change Management, H1 2027). Available at GA December 2026.

Atlas IBM's unified, AI-first control plane for the IBM Z environment. Replaces a collection of independent, siloed tools with a single intelligent system that understands, changes, and predicts across the entire z/OS estate. Organized around three intelligence pillars: System Intelligence, Change Intelligence, and Predictive Intelligence.

Atlas Base The core Atlas subscription. Includes System Intelligence (full) and Lean Change Intelligence (rate-limited). Available at GA, December 2026.

Atlas Provision An add-on SKU that unlocks full Atlas-native LPAR provisioning. Metered by provisioning events. Available H1 2027.

Atlas Test An add-on SKU that unlocks integration, regression, and performance test execution in Atlas. Metered by test execution events. Available H1 2027.

Bank of Z IBM's internal IBM Z environment used as the reference environment for Atlas development and demos. All discovered data in demo scenarios (component names, configuration values, transaction names) are drawn from the real Bank of Z discovery run completed 2026-07-03. Not a fictional or mocked environment.

Blast Radius The set of all components, applications, and systems that

could be affected if a given component fails, is compromised, or is changed. Computed by traversing the topology graph outward from a selected node. A key use case for Atlas — answering "what else does this touch?" before making a change.

Change Intelligence Atlas's second intelligence pillar. Delivers AI-generated change plans, automated test generation, environment provisioning, and safe change execution. Makes every change a proven one before production is touched. GA as MVP (Lean PTF Orchestration) in December 2026; full capability in H1 2027.

Config-as-Code (CaC) The practice and output of Atlas's discovery process: z/OS configuration is harvested from the live system and stored as structured YAML files in a version-controlled database. CaC is the primary data source for System Intelligence. Also refers to the discovery tooling (ZCONFIG, ZOSCONFIG) that produces these files.

Control Plane In Atlas context: the unified layer that sits above all IBM Z tools and provides shared intelligence, orchestration, and context. Atlas is designed to be the control plane for the IBM Z estate — not replacing individual tools, but connecting and coordinating them through shared system knowledge.

Lean Change Intelligence The rate-limited Change Intelligence capability included in Atlas Base at GA. Covers end-to-end PTF change orchestration (impact analysis → test plan → provisioning → function test execution). Rate-limited to create upsell pressure toward Atlas Provision and Atlas Test add-on SKUs.

Bob (for Z) IBM's AI assistant product offered as an optional integration with Atlas. Bob is a separate product from WXA4Z (watsonx Assistant for Z) — it is a customer-facing AI IDE experience that customers use as they would any other third-party developer tool, not as the Atlas inference engine. In the Atlas architecture, WXA4Z (FINN) is the embedded AI inference layer that powers Atlas's agentic chat, skills, and reasoning. Bob is an optional integration that provides a differentiated UX for Atlas customers who also use Bob as part of their development workflow. The Atlas–Bob integration UX is designed to make the distinction clear in the market. Also referenced as "Bob for Z" or simply "Bob." Do not describe Bob as the Atlas AI engine or as a replacement

for WXA4Z in Atlas documentation.

Pillar One of Atlas's three major value domains: System Intelligence, Change Intelligence, or Predictive Intelligence. Pillars exist for executive messaging, marketing narratives, and customer mental models. A use case may draw from more than one pillar. Pillars are not the primary organizing construct for engineering or design work — use cases are.

Predictive Intelligence Atlas's third intelligence pillar. Delivers continuous learning from real system behavior, config drift detection, DR validation, and anomaly prediction. Surfaces issues as warnings before they become incidents. MVP in H2 2027.

System Intelligence Atlas's first and foundational intelligence pillar. Delivers a complete, always-current model of the z/OS environment — infrastructure, middleware, software, and applications — shared as context across every Atlas capability. GA December 2026.

Topology Graph The core data structure of Atlas System Intelligence. A live, always-current graph database (built on Infragraph/HashiCorp) representing the entire z/OS environment as nodes (LPARs, subsystems, applications) and edges (relationships, connections, dependencies). Organized in three layers: Infrastructure (Layer 1), OS + Middleware (Layer 2), Applications (Layer 3). Every Atlas capability that reasons about the environment draws from this graph.

Tribal Knowledge Institutional knowledge about a z/OS environment that exists only in people's heads — not documented anywhere. A core problem Atlas solves: when experienced staff retire or leave, their knowledge should be captured in Atlas's topology graph rather than lost.

ZUA (IBM Z Upgrade Agent) A wxa4z-based AI skill that provides chat-guided z/OS upgrade assistance by front-ending z/OSMF APIs through a natural language interface. Capabilities include: FIXCAT and CRITICAL PTF gap detection, PTF acquisition via IBM Shopz, SMP/E installation orchestration, HOLD data management, and hardware compatibility checks for a target z/OS version. ZUA is scoped to z/OS upgrade currency — getting a system to the required PTF level for an upgrade. It does not perform compatibility impact analysis, sequencing risk detection, or test environment provisioning. In the Atlas architecture, ZUA runs as a skill inside the Atlas WXA4Z chat layer, providing the

execution primitive that Atlas's upgrade intelligence (see UC-02, UC-08) orchestrates on top of. See [positioning/atlas-and-zua-positioning.md](#) for the full positioning brief.

WXA4Z (watsonx Assistant for Z) IBM's AI assistant platform for IBM Z, also referred to simply as WXA. The AI inference and agentic chat layer embedded in Atlas. Provides natural language query across all topology and configuration data. WXA4Z v2 (code-named FINN) is the version used at TechXchange and GA — it introduces deep agentic capabilities: multi-step investigation, cross-system data correlation, remediation recommendations, and execution of approved actions with human oversight. Runs on a lightweight stack of 20–30 containers (vs. the 2500+ container footprint of earlier versions). Can run in-cluster (on-prem) or via SaaS. WXA4Z is evolving toward a full Agentic AI Operations Platform for IBM Z. Tier 1 agents use Spyre and small models for fast, privacy-focused on-prem deployment; Tier 2/3 agents use larger models for deep reasoning, planning, and autonomous workflows. An AI Optimizer routes intelligently across Spyre, on-prem GPU, and cloud/frontier models.

2. Milestones and Dates

July 15 (Internal Milestone) Internal development milestone. Capabilities available: Config-as-Code discovery, IZSAM Lite PTF inventory, BobShell agentic skills, static topology UI with CaC sidebar. Demo scenarios 1, 2, and 3 are viable at this milestone. TIB is not yet available.

August 19 (Internal Milestone) Internal development milestone. Capabilities added: Kubernetes Operator install, Vault OIDC, TIB with ZUnderstand + ZDLA + z/OSMF + IZSAM integrated, WXA4Z v2 (FINN) agentic chat, pan/zoom/filter topology UI. Demo scenarios 4 and 5 become viable. Multi-source queries across the full data set are available for the first time.

September 16 (Internal Milestone) Internal development milestone. Capabilities added: WXA4Z v2 in-cluster, agentic stack, multi-product

integration, Concert for Z, ZoC, Intellimagic, OMEGAMON, and ServiceNow integrations. Transaction flow queries and complex application relationship analysis available. Demo Scenario 6 becomes viable.

TechXchange (Private Preview) IBM TechXchange Conference, October 26, 2026. Atlas's first public appearance — a curated, invitation-only demo experience for enterprise customers against the Bank of Z environment. No customer data required. Target: ≥5 named enterprise accounts engaged. This is Phase 0 of the Atlas roadmap.

GA (General Availability) December 11, 2026. Atlas's official product launch. System Intelligence reaches full GA. Change Intelligence MVP (Lean PTF Orchestration) ships. First paid Atlas logos targeted. This is Phase 1 of the Atlas roadmap.

GA+1 (H1 2027) First half of 2027. Change Intelligence expands: full Atlas-native LPAR provisioning, integration and regression testing, MW/SW patch orchestration, application code change support. Atlas Provision and Atlas Test add-on SKUs launch.

GA+2 (H2 2027) Second half of 2027. Predictive Intelligence MVP ships: config drift detection, DR validation, production parity analysis, anomaly prediction. GitHub and ServiceNow integrations. Business service topology.

Phase 0 / Phase 1 / Phase 2 / Phase 3 / Phase 4 Atlas's internal roadmap phase labels. Phase 0 = TechXchange (Oct 2026). Phase 1 = GA (Dec 2026). Phase 2 = H1 2027. Phase 3 = H2 2027. Phase 4 = 2028+.

3. Use Case Taxonomy

Artifact A structured document or file generated by Atlas as the output of a use case interaction. Examples: System Intelligence Brief, Health Check Report, PTF Remediation Plan, Audit Evidence Package, Staff Onboarding Guide. Artifacts are versioned, exportable, and derive from

the live system model rather than from manual assembly.

Pillar See [Pillars](#) above. In the use case taxonomy: the top level of the three-level hierarchy (Pillar → Use Case → Scenario).

Scenario The third level of the Atlas use case hierarchy. A specific situation within a use case. Answers: *What instance of this customer goal is Atlas supporting?* Scenarios are where most detailed Atlas artifacts belong — conversation scripts, UX flows, state diagrams, agent workflows. Example: "Emergency CVE Response" is a scenario within the "Vulnerability Remediation" use case.

Supporting Artifact A document that describes *how* Atlas works within a scenario, rather than *what* the customer is trying to accomplish. Includes conversation scripts, state diagrams, UX flows, agent workflow specs, and screen flows. Supporting artifacts are linked from use cases and scenarios but are not first-class entries in the use case library.

Use Case The primary unit of customer value in the Atlas taxonomy. The second level of the three-level hierarchy (Pillar → Use Case → Scenario). Answers: *What business objective is the customer trying to accomplish?* Use cases are durable, customer-goal-oriented, and independent of UI implementation or specific AI workflow details. Atlas targets 10–15 core use cases. Example: "Patch Management" is a use case.

4. Architecture and Platform

Agentic Chat The conversational AI interface in Atlas through which users interact with the system using natural language. Powered by WXA4Z v2 (FINN). Can execute multi-step, multi-source queries across the topology graph, Config-as-Code database, PTF inventory, and integrated data sources. Available in full at the August 19 milestone.

Agentic Stack The collection of AI infrastructure components that enable Atlas's agentic behavior: WXA4Z v2 in-cluster, TIB, skill framework, and orchestration layer. ⚠ *Precise component list should be*

confirmed with the platform team.

Blueprint The working term used in Atlas UX to describe the topology view of a customer's environment — essentially, the visual representation of their system topology. The name "Blueprint" may not survive into the final product; it is a placeholder used during development. Do not treat it as a committed product term. In demo scenarios, Blueprint appears as a forward-looking Act 3 capability: a saved environment snapshot used as the template for provisioning a test sandbox.

Canvas The topology visualization surface in the Atlas UI. Displays the topology graph as an interactive diagram with pan, zoom, filter, and search. Nodes represent LPARs, subsystems, and applications; edges represent relationships and connections. Highlights and navigates based on chat intent at the Sept 16 milestone.

Config-as-Code Database (CaC DB) The structured database of YAML configuration files harvested from the live z/OS environment by the Atlas discovery agent. Populated by ZCONFIG and ZOSCONFIG discovery tooling. The primary data source for System Intelligence queries, topology graph construction, and all health and compliance assessments.

Discovery Agent The Atlas component deployed to the z/OS environment that harvests configuration data and builds the Config-as-Code database. Deployed via Kubernetes Operator (Aug 19+) or podman compose (July 15). Runs discovery across OS, middleware, software, and application layers.

FINN The internal code name for WXA4Z v2 — the second-generation AI inference layer used in Atlas. Finn introduces system-level inferencing and deep agentic capabilities. Runs as SaaS at the Aug 19 milestone; runs in-cluster at Sept 16.

HMC (Hardware Management Console) IBM hardware control interface for managing Central Electronics Complexes (CECs), LPARs, and sysplex configuration. A data source for Atlas Layer 1 (Infrastructure) topology discovery.

Infragraph The HashiCorp graph database component underlying the

Atlas topology graph. Purpose-built for infrastructure topology representation. Note: it is still undecided whether Atlas will use Infragraph or D3 rendering technology for topology visualization. Infragraph handles the graph data structure; D3 is an alternative for the rendering layer.

IPIC (IP Interconnectivity) An IBM CICS protocol for TCP/IP-based connections between CICS regions or between z/OS Connect and CICS. In the Bank of Z environment, z/OS Connect server `ZOSCSRV` connects to CICS region `CICSTS62` via IPIC on port 30709. The TLS state of the IPIC connection (`ssl: NO` in the Bank of Z discovery) is a key health finding.

Kubernetes Operator The deployment mechanism for Atlas at the August 19 milestone and beyond. Drives parallel deployment of Atlas Server, WXA4Z v2, and entitled products across Linux x86, Linux on Z, and zCX. Replaces the earlier podman compose install method.

LPAR (Logical Partition) A virtualized partition of an IBM Z mainframe (CEC). Each LPAR runs its own z/OS instance and set of middleware subsystems. LPARs are the primary unit of environment organization in Atlas's topology model and the anchor node for Layer 2 (middleware) discovery.

SAR/AAR Archives z/OS Connect EE service archive files that define the mapping between REST API endpoints and the underlying CICS or IMS transactions that serve them. SAR = Service Archive (used for CICS-backed APIs); AAR = Adapter Archive (used for IMS-backed APIs). Discovered by Atlas as part of z/OS Connect configuration harvest and used to map the API surface to application topology.

Skill In the Atlas/WXA4Z context: a discrete AI capability module that can be composed into agentic workflows. Examples: PTF inventory query skill, ibm.com PTF currency lookup skill, health check report generation skill, staff onboarding guide generation skill. Skills are the building blocks of Atlas's AI behavior.

SIT (System Initialization Table) The CICS startup parameter table that controls fundamental region behavior: security settings, key ring configuration, transaction routing, and subsystem connections. Harvested by Config-as-Code discovery. Key SIT parameters (e.g.,

xtran, xcmd, keyring) appear as topology node attributes in Atlas.

TIB (Topology Integration Broker) The middleware layer in Atlas that integrates multiple data sources into a unified query surface for the agentic chat and topology graph. TIB enables multi-source queries across Config-as-Code, IZSAM, ZUnderstand, ZDLA, z/OSMF, OMEGAMON, Concert for Z, and other integrations. Becomes available at the August 19 milestone. Without TIB, Atlas can only answer questions from Config-as-Code and IZSAM Lite. With TIB, Atlas can join data across all integrated sources in a single query.

z/OSMF (z/OS Management Facility) IBM's browser-based management interface for z/OS. A data source in Atlas's TIB integration layer, providing additional system inventory and management data. Used by Atlas primarily for CPC (Central Processor Complex) resource data and LPAR definitions as part of Layer 1 infrastructure discovery.

ZPARM (z/OS Parameter) A configuration parameter for a z/OS subsystem, most commonly used to refer to Db2 subsystem parameters (ZPARMs). Stored in the `DBD1.yml` Config-as-Code file for the Bank of Z Db2 instance. Atlas's health check analysis joins ZPARMs across multiple subsystems to surface cross-tool findings.

5. IBM Z Technology

CICS (Customer Information Control System) IBM's transaction processing middleware for z/OS. Manages real-time transaction execution for online applications. In the Bank of Z environment: region `CICSTS62`, CICS TS 6.2, hosting the BANK CSD group with 8 transactions.

CEC (Central Electronics Complex) The physical IBM Z mainframe hardware unit. Contains one or more LPARs. In Atlas's topology model: the root Layer 1 node that LPARs are anchored to.

CSD (CICS System Definition) The CICS resource definition database containing all defined transactions, programs, files, and connection

definitions for a CICS region. Harvested by Atlas Config-as-Code discovery. The BANK CSD group in the Bank of Z environment defines 8 transactions, 20+ programs, 9 file definitions, and the DB2CONN to Db2 subsystem `DBD1`.

DASD (Direct Access Storage Device) IBM Z disk storage. In Atlas's topology model: a Layer 1 node representing storage volumes and storage groups allocated to LPARs.

Db2 (Database 2) IBM's relational database management system for z/OS. In the Bank of Z environment: subsystem `DBD1`, Db2 13 V13R1M501. Atlas discovers Db2 ZPARMs, buffer pool configuration, authorization settings, and PTF state.

DDF (Distributed Data Facility) The Db2 component that enables distributed SQL connections — cross-subsystem or cross-system database access. In the Bank of Z: DDF ports 8100 (unsecured) and 8102 (TLS). Appears in Atlas topology as a Db2-to-Db2 edge.

FIXCAT (Fix Category) IBM's categorization system for PTFs. FIXCAT labels indicate why a PTF should be applied — e.g., `IBM.Security.Covert.Channel` flags a security-related fix. Atlas uses FIXCAT membership to prioritize PTF gap findings in health checks and vulnerability assessments.

GDPS (Geographically Dispersed Parallel Sysplex) IBM's disaster recovery and continuous availability solution for z/OS. Manages DR environment mirroring and failover coordination. In Atlas context: GDPS works together with IBM CyberVault technology to create an exact, mirrored copy of the production environment in an on-premises mirrored environment. Atlas plans to tap into these GDPS/CyberVault mirrored environments to provision high-fidelity isolated test and stress test environments without touching production. Planned for H2 2027+.

HIPER (High Impact PERvasive) A PTF classification for fixes addressing problems that are high-impact or pervasive across IBM Z installations. Atlas flags HIPER PTF gaps as higher priority than non-HIPER gaps in PTF currency analysis.

IMS (Information Management System) IBM's hierarchical database and transaction manager for z/OS. In the Bank of Z environment:

subsystem `IVP1`, IMS 15 DB/DC mode, sysplex `PLEX1`. Atlas discovers IMS TM and IMS DB configuration separately.

IPL (Initial Program Load) The z/OS equivalent of a system reboot. Some configuration changes require an IPL to take effect. Atlas flags IPL-required changes in its implementation plans.

ISPF (Interactive System Productivity Facility) The traditional IBM Z terminal interface for system administration. Requires deep expertise and knowledge of specific panel sequences. A core pain point Atlas addresses: tasks that previously required navigating ISPF panels can now be performed through Atlas's natural language chat.

JES2/JES3 (Job Entry Subsystem) IBM Z subsystems that manage batch job submission, scheduling, and spool management. In Atlas topology: Layer 2 nodes with spool configuration and initiator definitions. Spool allocation is a common DR drift finding.

MQ (IBM MQ for z/OS) IBM's message queuing middleware. Manages asynchronous messaging between applications. In the Bank of Z environment: queue manager `CSQ9`, MQ v9.4.2. Atlas discovers MQ channel definitions, authentication settings, TLS configuration, and queue depth configuration.

PTF (Program Temporary Fix) An IBM software patch for z/OS and IBM Z products. The most common change type on z/OS. Atlas's PTF capabilities include: inventory query (what is installed), currency check (what is available from IBM), gap analysis (what is missing and why it matters), impact assessment, and application planning.

RACF (Resource Access Control Facility) IBM Z's primary security and access control system. Manages user authentication, resource authorization, and audit logging across all z/OS subsystems. Atlas discovers RACF SETROPTS settings, key profiles, group definitions, and privileged access configurations. Appears in Atlas topology as a cross-cutting Layer 2 node that overlays all subsystem security.

RSU (Recommended Service Upgrade) IBM's periodic recommended PTF level for each z/OS product. Represents the set of PTFs IBM recommends all customers apply. Atlas compares installed PTF levels against the current RSU to identify gaps and flag missing fixes.

SMP/E (System Modification Program Extended) IBM Z's software maintenance tool for receiving, applying, and tracking PTFs. Atlas generates SMP/E RECEIVE and APPLY JCL as part of its PTF remediation plans. Atlas does not execute SMP/E operations directly — it generates the JCL for human review and approval.

Monoplex A single IBM Z mainframe system running independently. A monoplex is powerful, reliable, and capable of handling massive workloads — but it operates as a standalone environment. If that system goes down, the workload goes with it. Maintenance windows, outages, and scaling are all constrained by the limits of that one system. In Atlas context: Change Intelligence testing at GA is restricted to monoplex virtual LPAR environments. Customers operating production workloads on a sysplex (Parallel Sysplex) will have reduced test environment fidelity at GA because the test environment cannot replicate sysplex configuration. Sysplex testing support is a post-GA expansion priority. See also: **Sysplex**.

Sysplex (Parallel Sysplex) A cluster of multiple IBM Z mainframes connected into a unified, cooperative environment. Instead of thinking in terms of one system, a Parallel Sysplex is a cluster that behaves like a single logical entity: workloads can be distributed dynamically, resources can be shared across LPARs, and there is no single point of failure because multiple systems share the workload. The Coupling Facility is the hardware component that enables LPARs to share data and synchronize work. The highest-level logical grouping of LPARs in Atlas's topology model. In the Bank of Z environment: `PLEX1`. In Atlas context: sysplex topology discovery is supported at GA (Atlas can model and explain a sysplex environment). Sysplex provisioning — creating test environments that replicate sysplex topology — is not supported at GA and is a post-GA expansion priority. Sysplex-to-monoplex transformation is explicitly out of scope. See also: **Monoplex**.

USS (UNIX System Services) The UNIX subsystem embedded in z/OS, providing a POSIX-compatible environment. USS file systems (zFS mount points) are a data source for Atlas configuration discovery, particularly for z/OS Connect server configuration.

z/OS IBM's flagship mainframe operating system. The primary platform Atlas is built for and deployed on. All Atlas discovery, topology modeling,

and change intelligence is scoped to z/OS environments.

z/OS Connect (z/OS Connect EE) IBM middleware that exposes z/OS transactions (CICS, IMS) as REST APIs. Creates a REST API gateway layer on top of mainframe applications. In the Bank of Z environment: started task `ZOSCSRVR`, 10 REST APIs exposed on HTTPS port 9443, connected to CICS via IPIC port 30709. A key topology node in Atlas because it bridges the external API world with the internal z/OS transaction world.

zCX (z/OS Container Extensions) IBM's container runtime for z/OS that allows Linux containers to run natively on mainframe hardware.

Atlas deployment to zCX is deferred to GA+2 (H2 2027). At GA (December 2026) and at TechXchange (October 2026), Atlas is deployed on Linux x86 and Linux on Z only. TechXchange demo environments use zTrial and ZVA environments, not zCX. The zCX deployment target will be added to Atlas in Phase 3 (GA+2, H2 2027) as part of the platform expansion. See also: **ZVA, zTrial**.

6. Data Sources and Integrations

Concert for Z (C4Z) IBM's operational monitoring and event management platform for IBM Z. Also referred to as C4Z. A TIB integration target for Atlas at the September 16 milestone. In Atlas context, Concert for Z contributes PTF risk data — specifically risk scores about unapplied APARs, HIPERs, and PE (Program Error) PTFs. This enriches Atlas's vulnerability and patch management use cases with risk-weighted prioritization. Atlas and Concert for Z are complementary: Atlas handles topology, change, and prediction; Concert handles operational monitoring.

CyberVault IBM's data isolation and cyber resiliency technology. Works together with GDPS to create an exact mirrored copy of the production environment in an on-premises environment. In Atlas context: Atlas plans to use the GDPS/CyberVault combination to quickly provision high-fidelity isolated environments for stress testing and full DR validation scenarios. Planned for H2 2027+.

Intellimagic A third-party performance analysis and capacity planning tool for IBM Z. A TIB integration target for Atlas at the September 16 milestone. Provides SMF-based performance analytics that Atlas draws on for Predictive Intelligence and performance diagnosis use cases.

IZSAM / IZSAM Lite IBM Z Software Asset Management. Provides installed software product inventory and PTF state per LPAR. IZSAM Lite is the lightweight version used in Atlas's early discovery pipeline. The PTF inventory data source for Atlas health checks and currency assessments. Available at the July 15 milestone.

OMEGAMON IBM's performance monitoring suite for z/OS subsystems (CICS, Db2, MQ, IMS, z/OS). A TIB integration target at the September 16 milestone. Provides real-time and historical performance telemetry. Used by Atlas for the Application Performance Diagnosis use case and for Predictive Intelligence signal analysis.

Optim (IBM Optim Test Data Management) IBM's test data management and masking tool, primarily for Db2 and IMS. Optim is a future integration for Atlas — not a GA dependency. At GA, functional testing uses TAZ skills with whatever test data is available in the provisioned environment. In a future release (H1 2027+), Atlas plans to integrate Optim to support test-data management workflows: creating realistic, compliant test datasets, masking production data for test use, and generating synthetic test data. This integration will improve the fidelity of functional and integration test results and unlock test scenarios requiring specific data states. The commercial and packaging relationship between Optim and Atlas has not yet been finalized.

ServiceNow ITSM (IT Service Management) platform used by many IBM Z customers for change management and incident tracking. A TIB integration target for Atlas at the September 16 milestone. In H2 2027, Atlas adds bi-directional ServiceNow integration: Atlas changes are automatically linked to ServiceNow change records.

ZDLA (IBM Z Discovery Library Adapter) An internal IBM component that discovers many aspects of a z/OS environment — similar in scope to what ZCONFIG captures, but via a different discovery mechanism. Provides real-time and historical performance telemetry to Atlas via TIB. Used for capacity analysis and performance diagnosis scenarios.

Available in TIB at the August 19 milestone.

ZCONFIG An internal Atlas component name for the Config-as-Code discovery tooling that harvests configuration from standard z/OS subsystems (CICS, Db2, MQ, IMS, RACF) into YAML files. Not a separate IBM product — a capability being delivered as part of Atlas via the operating system and middleware layers. Internal name subject to change.

ZoC (z Observability Connect) A new IBM Z offering that allows teams to map application relationships and understand them dynamically using OpenTelemetry standards. Provides dynamic, real-time application topology data to Atlas via TIB at the September 16 milestone. Complements ZUnderstand (which provides static analysis) by adding runtime observability.

ZOSCONFIG An internal Atlas component name for the Config-as-Code discovery tooling specific to z/OS Connect EE. Harvests z/OS Connect server definitions, API inventories (SAR/AAR archives), and connection configurations into YAML files. Like ZCONFIG, this is an Atlas-internal capability delivered via the middleware layer, not a separate IBM product. Internal name subject to change.

ZUnderstand An internal IBM component, formerly known as IBM ADDI for z/OS (Application Discovery and Delivery Intelligence). Also used in Bob for Z. Maps application components and their relationships statically — meaning it analyzes source code and definitions rather than live runtime behavior. Provides static application topology to Atlas via TIB at the August 19 milestone. Contrast with ZoC (z Observability Connect), which provides dynamic runtime topology via OpenTelemetry.

zSecure Portal IBM's security intelligence platform for z/OS. Planned integration for vulnerability PTF handling in Atlas — specifically, the ability to surface security-driven PTF requirements through the vulnerability remediation workflow. A dependency for the proactive CVE detection path. If integration slips from GA, the security PTF scenario narrows to what Atlas can derive from IZSAM and ibm.com PTF data alone.

ZVA (IBM Z Virtual Access) IBM's infrastructure environment that provides virtual access to IBM Z systems for development and testing

purposes. Used as the demo and early access environment for Atlas at TechXchange (October 2026). Along with zTrial, ZVA is one of two primary infrastructure environments used for the Atlas TechXchange demo — replacing zCX, which is deferred to GA+2. *△ Precise ZVA capabilities and relationship to the TechXchange demo environment should be confirmed with the platform team.*

zTrial (IBM Z Trial) IBM's trial environment for customers to access IBM Z capabilities without owning a physical mainframe. Used as an infrastructure environment for the Atlas TechXchange (October 2026) demo alongside ZVA. Along with ZVA, zTrial is one of two primary infrastructure environments used for the Atlas TechXchange demo — replacing zCX, which is deferred to GA+2. *△ Precise zTrial capabilities and relationship to the TechXchange demo environment should be confirmed with the platform team.*

7. Commercial and Packaging

Attach Rate The percentage of IBM Z software portfolio customers who also purchase Atlas. Increasing attach rate across the existing IBM Z software portfolio is IBM Business Objective #2 for Atlas.

Logo In sales context: a paying customer account. "First paid logos at GA" is the Phase 1 commercial target — meaning Atlas's first signed and paying enterprise customers.

NSM (North Star Metric) The single most important metric for measuring Atlas's success at a given roadmap phase. Phase 1 NSM: weekly active artifacts generated per connected environment. Phase 2 NSM: % of environment change events that begin in Atlas. Phase 3 NSM: % of z/OS change lifecycle managed end-to-end in Atlas.

Portfolio Gateway Atlas's long-term (2028+) commercial capability: surfacing recommendations for relevant IBM Z software products based on detected environment gaps, and enabling direct procurement and activation of those products from within Atlas. Positions Atlas as the front door to the IBM Z software portfolio.

SKU (Stock Keeping Unit) A distinct purchasable product. Atlas has three SKUs planned: Atlas Base (GA Dec 2026), Atlas Provision (H1 2027), Atlas Test (H1 2027). A fourth, Atlas Portfolio Gateway, is planned for 2028+.

8. Metrics and Measurement

Artifact Generation The act of Atlas producing a structured output document (health check report, onboarding guide, audit evidence package, etc.) in response to a user request. The leading indicator metric for Phase 1 — weekly active artifact generation rate measures whether Atlas is being actively used to drive decisions.

Config Drift The divergence of a system's actual configuration state from a defined baseline or peer environment. A core Predictive Intelligence capability: Atlas continuously monitors for drift and alerts when material differences are detected. A common cause of DR test failures and "test doesn't look like prod" problems.

Dark Capacity Compute, memory, or storage resources on IBM Z that are allocated but not actively used. Atlas surfaces dark capacity as part of the Capacity Planning use case — giving infrastructure teams data to make procurement and reclamation decisions.

Environment Parity The degree to which two environments (e.g., production and QA, or production and DR) have the same configuration, PTF levels, and access controls. Atlas measures and monitors parity as a continuous state rather than a point-in-time check.

PDLC Product Development Lifecycle. IBM's internal framework for product development phases (Discovery, Delivery, Growth). Not an Atlas-specific term but used in the IBM Winning Products methodology that Atlas PM work follows.

Time-to-Value How quickly a customer gets meaningful value after deploying Atlas. A core Atlas design principle: meaningful results within the first hour of deployment, deployable in under two hours. Rapid time-

to-value is required for Atlas's commercial motion.

This glossary is maintained by Product Management. To propose additions or corrections, edit this file and note the change in the version date. Terms marked △ should be verified with the relevant technical or product team before the next external use.